

# NIA MUCHER

Herndon, VA · Charlottesville, VA · uma8fb@virginia.edu · (260) 705-6202

AI Safety & Governance · Education Technology

## EDUCATION

### B.A., Computer Science & History · GPA: 3.86

August 2025 – Present

University of Virginia · Charlottesville, VA

### A.S., Computer Science · GPA: 3.91

September 2023 – May 2025

Northern Virginia Community College · Annandale, VA

## AI SAFETY & GOVERNANCE EXPERIENCE

### Incoming Vice President — Virginia AI Security Initiative

May 2026 – Present

UVA student organization on AI governance & catastrophic risk · Charlottesville, VA

- ❖ Lead a 40+ member student organization focused on AI governance and catastrophic risk mitigation, setting strategic direction across governance, technical research, and outreach programming.
- ❖ Coordinate with university faculty and partner AI safety organizations on programming and fellowship design.

### Technical Research Team

January 2026 – Present

Virginia AI Security Initiative · Charlottesville, VA

- ❖ Replicated and extended Anthropic's emotion-vector interpretability methodology (Sofroniew et al., 2026) on the open-weight Gemma 2 2B model; published findings to the VAISI Substack.

### AI Governance Fellow

January – May 2026

Virginia AI Security Initiative · Charlottesville, VA

- ❖ Authored a policy memo proposing reform of Virginia's data-center tax exemptions to require compute contributions for public redistribution, expanding access to AI and education infrastructure.

### Research Assistant — AI Bias & Education

January 2026 – Present

UVA Engineering, advised by Prof. David Evans · Charlottesville, VA

- ❖ First-authored a paper accepted at AIES 2026 (AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society) presenting an audit framework to detect racial bias in AI image generators, developed with law students to ground it for use in publicly funded institutions.
- ❖ Briefed Albemarle County Public Schools (ACPS) and Canva on audit findings to inform procurement decisions; brokered institutional partnerships with both organizations.

### Program Committee Member, AIES 2026

Spring 2026

- ❖ Reviewed submitted research on AI ethics, governance, and social impact for a leading interdisciplinary AI ethics conference.

### Technology Innovation & Experimentation Intern

June – August 2025

National Museum of African American History and Culture (NMAAHC) · Washington, D.C.

- ❖ Authored white papers and policy summaries on AI regulation in cultural institutions; briefed senior executives on global AI technology trends.
- ❖ Designed and pitched an AI-enhanced visitor experience initiative adopted for further development by museum leadership.

## EDUCATION TECHNOLOGY EXPERIENCE

### Student Technology Council

Incoming Fall 2026

University of Virginia, est. by Prof. Mona Sloane (Sloane Lab, Karsh Institute of Democracy) · Charlottesville, VA

- ❖ Selected as one of two class representatives to UVA's inaugural Student Technology Council, the first student body in the country advising a university on technology procurement, innovation, and AI governance.

### Education Technology Intern

January – May 2026

mEducation Alliance · Arlington, VA

- ❖ Assessed mobile STEM kit efficacy across 20+ countries through stakeholder interviews with Ministries of Education and NGOs; produced digital content for global ed-tech access campaigns.

### Principal Investigator, AR & Public History

May 2026 – Present

UVA Architectural History, advised by Prof. Louis Nelson · Charlottesville, VA

- ❖ Conducting IRB-approved research on augmented reality as a lever for public engagement with historical sites; producing a digital history project on UVA's anatomical theatre.

### Substitute Teacher

December 2024 – June 2025

Fairfax County Public Schools · Fairfax County, VA

- ❖ Delivered instruction to diverse student populations, including English Language Learners and students with disabilities, using assistive and digital learning tools.

### Invited Panelist, K-12 Coalition Think Tank

March 2026

- ❖ Contributed practitioner-informed insights to national discussions on instructional practice, ed-tech, and professional development.

## VOLUNTEERING

CoLab Mentor, Computers for Kids (C4K) · Event Photographer Volunteer, Jefferson School African American Heritage Center · Agricultural Volunteer, Morven Farm

## HONORS & AWARDS

Robert Kent Gooch Scholarship, UVA College of Arts & Sciences — for students with qualities of mind and character considered requisite for selection of Rhodes Scholars.

Undergraduate Researcher Award, UVA Dept. of Computer Science — recognizes excellence in CS research, selected annually by faculty.

Kenan Award, UVA Office of Citizen Scholar Development — \$5,000 grant; one of five awarded university-wide for research on UVA's Academical Village.

## SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

**AI & Research:** AI Safety & Governance, AI Research, Algorithm Design, Human Subjects Research, Qualitative Methods, White Paper & Policy Writing

**Technical:** Python, Java, JavaScript, HTML, Adobe Creative Suite, Google Workspace, Canva, PyTorch

**Communication & Media:** Graphic Design, Video Production & Editing, Photography, Newsletter Development